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WAM

MOHAMMED ATTENDS OPEN MASTERS GAMES

■ His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, attends competitions of the Open Masters Games Abu Dhabi 2026 at the Abu Dhabi National Exhibition Centre. The event brings together more than 25,000 athletes representing over 92 nationalities, competing across 38 sports, including six traditional disciplines and 13 sports for People of Determination. **SEE ALSO P14**

New 600m, four-lane bridge to ease traffic on Al Qudra Road

It boosts capacity by 191 per cent, from 6,600 to 19,200 vehicles an hour

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

Dubai's Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) opened a 600-metre bridge comprising four lanes at the intersection of Al Qudra Road and the link road connecting Arabian Ranches with Dubai Studio City, as part of the main intersections development project along Al Qudra Road. The newly-completed bridge improves traffic flow on Al Qudra Road and the connecting road between Arabian Ranches and Dubai Studio City, increases capacity by 191 per cent, from 6,600 vehicles per hour to 19,200 vehicles

70%

cut in travel time,
from 9.4 minutes
to 2.8 minutes on
project completion

per hour, and reduces waiting time at the junction by 55 per cent, cutting delays from 113 seconds to 52 seconds.

The corridor extends from its intersection with Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Road, passing through Sheikh Zayed Bin Hamdan Al Nahyan Street and Emirates Road, and continuing along Al Qudra Road.

RTA will open the northern (left side) bridge on February 15 at the intersection of Al Qudra Road and Sheikh Zayed Bin Hamdan Al Nahyan Street. The 700-metre bridge provides two lanes in each direc-

tion, pending completion of works on the southern (right-side) bridge. The structure will serve traffic along Al Qudra Road towards Al Qudra City and in the direction of Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Road.

400,000 served

Mattar Al Tayer, Director-General, Chairman of the Board of Executive Directors, Roads and Transport Authority, said, "[Al Qudra Road Development] project includes upgrading several key intersections, and constructing bridges extending 2,700 metres, as well as widening and improving the existing road over a total length of 11.6km. It will increase road capacity and cut journey time by 70 per cent, reducing travel time from 9.4 minutes to 2.8 minutes. The project will serve residential and development areas accommodating an estimated 400,000 residents and visitors."

SEE ALSO P2

Trump plans Board of Peace meeting to raise Gaza funds

February 19 talks aim to bring together world leaders in Washington

WASHINGTON

US President Donald Trump plans to convene the first meeting of his Board of Peace this month in Washington to raise money for the reconstruction of Gaza.

The meeting, proposed for Feb. 19, would include both world leaders who accepted Trump's invitation in January to join the board as well as members of an executive committee for Gaza that will oversee the specifics of the territory's governance, security and redevelopment, two Trump administration officials said Saturday. It was not immediately clear how many leaders would accept the Republican president's invitation, accord-

ing to the officials, who spoke on condition of anonymity.

'Robust' participation

One official said the administration expected "robust" participation. A copy of the invitation that was sent late Friday to invited participants says the meeting will be held at the US Institute of Peace, now known as the Donald J. Trump US Institute of Peace, pending an ongoing legal battle with the former leadership of the non-profit think tank.

Trump's new board was first seen as a mechanism focused on ending the Israel-Hamas war in Gaza. But it has taken shape with his ambition for a far broader mandate of resolving global crises and appears to be the latest US effort to side-step the United Nations. Many of America's top allies have declined to join what they suspect may be an attempt to rival the Security Council. — AP

SEE ALSO P6, 10

UAE welcomes US-Iran talks, calls for peace

US MILITARY DEPLOYMENT DOES NOT SCARE US, IRAN FM ARAGHCHI SAYS

ABU DHABI

The UAE welcomed talks between the United States and Iran in Oman, affirming that this positive development reflects ongoing efforts to advance dialogue and promote de-escalation.

In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) expressed its appreciation for the efforts undertaken by Oman to foster an environment conducive to dialogue, commending its hosting of the talks as a step that reflects Oman's constructive role in advancing mutual understanding at the regional and international levels, and in promoting regional security and stability.

The UAE reiterated its belief that strengthening dialogue and de-escalation, upholding international law, and respecting the sovereignty of states constitute the most effective framework for addressing current crises, underscoring its steadfast commitment to resolving differences through diplomatic means. Furthermore, the UAE expressed its hope that these consultations will yield positive outcomes that contribute to de-escalation, strengthen regional security and stability, and support regional and international peace.

Defiant stand

Meanwhile, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi yesterday ruled out Tehran ever giving up uranium enrichment in its negotiations with Washington, insisting it will not be intimidated by the threat of war with the

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi told a forum that Tehran had little trust in Washington and even doubted that the US side was taking renewed negotiations seriously.

United States. The minister told a forum that Tehran had little trust in Washington and even doubted that the US side was taking renewed negotiations seriously.

"Why do we insist so much on enrichment and refuse to give it up, even if a war is imposed on us? Because no one has the right to dictate our behaviour," Araghchi said.

He dismissed US military deployments in the region, saying, "Their military deployment in the region does not scare us."

Araghchi's comments came after US lead negotiators Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner visited the USS Abraham Lincoln on Saturday, signalling the persistent threat of US military action against Iran. Araghchi also called into question the United States' commitment to negotiations.

"The continuation of certain sanctions and military actions raise doubts about the seriousness and readiness of the other side to conduct genuine negotiations," he added.

"We are monitoring the situation closely, assessing all the signals and will decide on the continuation of the negotiations."

— Agencies

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TELL ME WHY



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SPORT

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